UNIT-4
LECTURE-1

MEMORANDUM (MEMOS)

MEMOS-INTRODUCTION

- There are three important channels through which information flows within the various sections of an organization
- Employees can communicate **face-to-face, over a telephone** or **through <u>an inter- office memorandum, i.e. a memo</u>**
- Memos are written by everyone from junior executives and engineers to chief Executive Officers.
- It could be a small piece of paper with a letter head that says something like this---------..
- “From the desk of…..” or “ Don’t forget….” or “Reminders….”
- The message may be very simple, like-----
- ‘Buy more paper clips’, ‘Meet with President at 10.30am.” “we are running out of shortage of space.

MEMOS-INTRODUCTION

- Memos are informative or persuasive and may serve simple purpose
- **Memos are brief written communications circulated within an organization.**
- They not only facilitate communication about various operations but also play an important role In arriving at some quick decisions.
- **Eg**-production manager of a fabrics company can decide which type of fabric needs to be produced more on the basis of information in memo provided by marketing manager.
- Memos solve problems either by informing the reader about new information , like policy changes, price increases etc. or by persuading the reader to take an action like—attend a meeting, use less paper, or change in the current production procedure.
- Inter office memorandum enable the flow of information in all the three types of organizational communication, - vertical, horizontal , and diagonal.eg-The president of an organization can send a memo to vice president etc….
- In short , **memos help in bridging the communication gap among the various sections of any organization and also serve as permanent records of information.**

MEMOS- Classification

- Written communication reaches so many people at so many levels so does a memo.
- The larger the organization you work for and more levels of authority it has, the more inefficient phone call and face-to-face discussion become.
- A memo is a good way to reach many people at once.
- It is important not only because of its frequency of use and the wide range of subject matter presented in memo form, but also because it represents a component of interpersonal communication skills within your work environment .
- **Depending on their purpose , memos can be** classified into three major categories:
- i**) Documentary**
- **ii) Congratulatory**
- **iii) Disciplinary**

MEMOS- Classification

- **i)Documentary memo:**
- Used for conveying information.
- You may write a memo to your subordinate to remind, to announce, to give instructions, to explain a policy or procedure, to a peer or superior to make a request or routine recommendation, or to confirm an agreement.
- **eg**: explaining the new method of maintain the medical records of employees. Requesting other divisional head for providing additional man power for shifting huge machines etc.
- **Short reports also can be submitted in the form of documentary memos.**
- Such reports are called as **memo reports.**

MEMOS- Classification

- **ii)Congratulatory Memo**:
- To give credit to employees of an organization for outstanding work the have accomplished.
- Eg: Vice- Chancellor of University sending a memo to the faculty members congratulating their outstanding contribution to the field of research.
- similarly employees can send their complements in the form of a memo to their officers for their achievements
- **iii)Disciplinary Memo**:
- When employees violate the rules or breach the code of conduct in an organization, they will be served either with a severe warning or any other punishment as decided by the management .
- Eg-A memo may be issued to an officer who has accepted a bribe .

Memo- Structure and Layout

- Standard memos are divided into **five segments** to organize information and to help the writer's purpose**.**
- **i)Heading Segment**
- **ii)Opening Segment**
- **iii)Discussion Segment**
- **iv)Closing Segment**
- **v)Signature Segment**
- **Vi**)Necessary Attachment segment (**optional)**
- **Vii)**Distribution Segment(**optional)**

Memo- Structure and Layout

- **i)Heading Segment:**
- **The heading segment follows this general format:**
- **Name of the organization and address** :(printed letterhead)
- **Date**: (complete and current date)- **April 07,2021 and 07April2021**
- **To:** (designation of the recipient)
- **From:** (Designation of the sender)
- **Subject:** (what the memo is about , highlights in some way)
- Almost every recipient reads the subject line which gives clear idea of what topic is discussed in the memo.
- , **Subject is typed in CAPITALS** where you begin talking to your reader. One word subject line do not communicate effectively .
- Eg- PERMISSION TO CHANGE PROCEDURE
- REQUEST FOR FOUR MACHINES
- DETAILS OF TRAINING PROGRAMME

Memo- Structure and Layout

- **II) Opening Segment:**
- The purpose of memo is usually found in the opening **paragraphs and is presented in three parts** :
- **i)The context and problem,**
- **ii)the specific assignment or task**
- **iii)The purpose of the memo**
- **1. The context is the event**, circumstances, or background of the problem, you are solving or the topic you are handling in your memo.
- You may use a paragraph to establish the background and state the problem or simply the opening of a sentence .
- Include only what your reader needs, but be sure it is clear.

Memo- Structure and Layout

- **2. In the task statement** you should describe what you are doing to help solve the problem.
- If the action was requested , your task may be indicated by a sentence opening like---'you asked that I look at…'
- If you want to explain your intentions, you might say ,"To determine the best method of controlling the percentage of absenteeism, I took recourse to three methods…"
- **3.The purpose statement of a memo** gives your reason for writing it and forecasts what is in the rest of the memo.
- Ensure that the statement is forthright and explains to the reader exactly what is in store.
- eg-you might say " This memo presents a description of the current situation , some proposed alternatives, and my recommendations."
- Include only as needed by the decision makers in the context.
- Do more planning before you are ready to write a memo
- **Your memo should start with one or two clear sentences to tell your reader the need and purpose of your communication**.

Memo- Structure and Layout

ii)Discussion:

- These are parts where you develop the arguments that support your ideas
- Eg-, if you write a memo to your superiors who has asked you to analyse the feasibility of offering some new services to employees, you can explain the details of your analysis in this section.
- If you are directing your subordinate to conduct a survey on the working effectiveness of new machines introduced in your division, you can give the specific details regarding the aspects you want to be examined .
- Since very few readers read every line of the memos they receive, keep your communication brief.
- **Eg**- The machines were not properly checked as soon as they were received . They were sent to production division directly.

Memo- Structure and Layout

- **Closing:**
- After the reader has absorbed all of your information , you want to **close it with courteous ending** that states what action you want your readers to take.
- Always consider how the reader will benefit from the desired actions and how you can make those actions easier.
- Eg- ”I will be glad to discuss this recommendation with you during our Tuesday trip to Delhi and follow through on any decisions you make.”
- Your memo can end with some **complimentary remarks** or **directive statements.**
- While a **complimentary close motivates y**our readers and makes them feel happy , a directive close tells them what exactly you want them to do next or what your plans are.
- **Eg- please accept my complements to you for introducing this new computing system in your division**.
- There is no doubt that your conscientious efforts would help us accomplish our task without any difficulty . Keep it up!

Memo- Structure and Layout

- **Closing:**
- **Directive Close:**
- Eg- I would like to resolve the issue only after hearing from you. Hence ,kindly inform me before 25th April 21.
- To complete your analysis in time , our Finance manager would provide the necessary data tomorrow, the 6th April21. please bring along with you the registration details of the newly acquired land.
- **V) Signature segment:**
- **Vi) Necessary Attachments:**
- Make sure your document your findings or provide detailed information whenever necessary.
- You can do this by attaching lists, graphs, tables, maps , etc. at the end of your memo.
- Be sure to refer your attachments in your memo and add a notation about what is attached below your closing
- Attached: Director's approval letter
- Attached: list of trainees and trainers

Memo- Structure and Layout

- **Vii)Distribution Segment(optional)**
- This last segment is used to mention the designations of those people to whom you would like to send a copy or some copies of your memo.
- This segment is not mandatory in a memo.
- The short form of complimentary copy is: Cc, can be used instead of the word distribution.
- **Distribution** / **Cc**: Assistant Manager Finance
- Supervisor , Manufacturing

Memo- structure and layout

National Steel Industries Ltd.
12, Gandhi Marg, New Delhi -110002

Interoffice Memorandum

Date:06April2021

To: All Section Heads

From: General Manager

Subject: WASTAGE OF STATIONERY

---(opening)
---(Discussion)
---(Closing)

Signature
Attachment
Distribution:

Memo- Style

- Your organization and your relationship with your readers suggest the degree of formality or informality you should adopt in your memos.
- In some companies , a formal style is expected ; In others , a handwritten note or informality in style is the rule
- Some bosses –those who believe in the importance of upholding status distinctions-want your memos to sound formal and distant in a way that is appropriate to your subordinate position.
- Those who have an open and participative approach to managing –want you to use the first **person, contractions , and even sentences fragments to create an informal and conversational style.**
- Hence, while reading a memo, choose the style that suits you but keep in mind that a friendly tone and courtesy are always required to suggest your association with the reader.
- Generally your tone will be neutral or positive , but you may occasionally have to issue complaints or reprimand in memo form.

Memo- Style

- Use caution in a negative situation , and be aware of the effect of your correspondence.
- Ostentatious language , excessively technical jargons, or complicated syntax will make you sound pompous.
- Develop a relaxed and conversational style without being too chatty.
- If you project an image of consideration , you stand a much greater chance of being viewed as knowledgeable and competent in carrying out your professional responsibilities.
- Make sure to keep your memos as short and to-the-point as possible.
- Whether the news is good , bad, , or neutral , state your point in the opening segment.
- If the memo is lengthy you should provide an indication of its organization in the opening segment.

Practice question- drafting memo

ELITE CYCLE LTD.
Ahamadnagar, Maharashtra
_____ _____ _www.elit cycles_____
Interoffice Memorandum

Date: 07April2021

To: Production Manager

From: Personal Manager

Subject: CHANGE IN WORKING HOURS

Please refer to your memo pd/21 dated 02April2021 ,requesting for a change in the working hours of your division because of the extremely hot whether conditions.

As desired by you , the Vice President , Personnel, has agreed to change the working hours. The new timings will be 8am to 2pm. (Monday to Saturday) with effect from 10April2020-21.

Kindly inform all the employees working under you.

K.S.Sharma